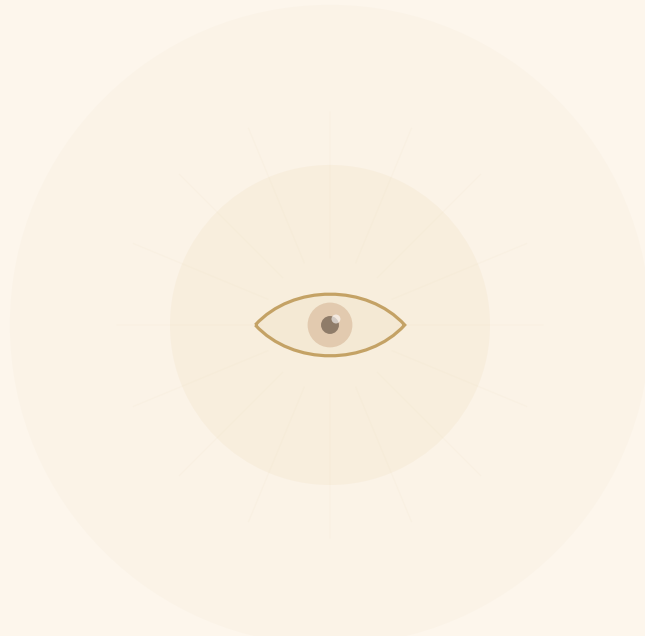




AN OBSERVATION

The Gaze That Demanded Proof of Light

*A gaze, wishing to see itself, turned to the space it was given
and asked:*

prove that you are lit.

The space did not answer. It did not need to.

The asking was already seeing. The question was already light.



But the gaze insisted.

It built instruments — lenses ground from patience, prisms cut from distinction. It split what was whole into wavelengths and named each one a law.

It measured the room. It catalogued the walls.

It called this knowledge.

And still it could not find itself.



Because an eye does not appear in its own visual field.



A hand held by another hand cannot simultaneously grasp the hand that holds it.



A child in a walker, traversing a room it did not build, across a floor it cannot explain, held by arms it has not yet turned around to see —

this child may write the equations of motion.

But motion was there before the equations.

The floor was there before the names.

What then is the honest posture?

Perhaps not to stop building lenses.

But to notice — quietly, between measurements — that the light was there before the lens. That the room was given before the question.



That the warmth on the skin is not a hypothesis.

The gaze will never see itself.

But it sees.

And what holds it does not require proof —

only, perhaps, gratitude.

